

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

HIGHLAND PARK PARADE SHOOTING

Gunman gets life in prison without parole



Members of the Uvaldo family react as Judge Victoria Rossetti sentences Robert Crimo III at the Lake County Courthouse in Waukegan on Thursday. Crimo was sentenced to seven consecutive life sentences without the possibility of parole. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Survivors hug each other for comfort as victims' names are read by judge

By Robert McCoppin and Joseph States
Chicago Tribune

Victims of the mass shooting at the Highland Park Fourth of July parade in 2022 have one consolation in the aftermath of the deadly attack: The gunman will spend the rest of his life in prison.

Following Robert Crimo III's guilty plea last month, the law required he receive a life sentence. Lake County Judge Victoria Rossetti went on Thursday to mete out seven life sentences — one for each person Crimo killed — plus 50 years for

the spectators wounded in 48 cases of attempted murder.

For those who survived or lost loved ones, the punishment was a measure of justice even though some said they would have preferred Crimo's execution. Yet for all the evidence that came out of the hearing about the killer's years of planning the attack, the mass shooting remained tragic and inexplicable.

Only the response of those affected was at times heroic. Victims protected and helped each other while bullets rained down on them. Police rushed to respond to the danger, to get

medical help, and track down the offender. Survivors who saved each other at the scene now hugged to comfort each other as each victim's name was read by the judge, along with the accompanying sentence.

Those gathered in court welcomed the conclusion of the case as a relief. Some vowed to continue trying to recover from the attack, while acknowledging that lost lives and innocence can never be replaced.

"A mass shooting is like a bomb blast throughout a community," said Highland Park resident Erica Weeder, who was injured in

the attack alongside her husband. "Because of this mass shooting, this act of terror, I, my children, and our entire community now know that no one is ever really safe."

Crimo did not attend the two-day hearing, prompting victims to call him a coward. The sentencing was briefly halted when there came word that Crimo would show up, but the proceedings continued after it was revealed he was upset that jailers had taken some books from him, including the Quran,

Turn to Sentencing, Page 2

EMIL JONES III TRIAL



State Sen. Emil Jones III talks to reporters after his bribery trial ended in a mistrial on Thursday at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Mistrial declared after jury deadlocks

Trial's conclusion comes after nearly 3 weeks of testimony

By Jason Meisner, Caroline Kubzansky, Sam Charles and Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

After deliberating for nearly as many hours as they heard evidence, jurors in the corruption trial of state Sen. Emil Jones III on Thursday could not reach a unanimous decision, leaving the case to end in a mistrial after nearly three weeks of testimony and arguments.

The trial's conclusion without a verdict came after jurors for two days signaled that they were struggling to come to an agreement while weighing three counts against Jones, who was charged with agreeing to take bribes from an executive of a red-light camera company in exchange for Jones' protection in Springfield against legislation that would hurt the company's bottom line.

Flanked by his attorneys as he left the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse, Jones, 46, thanked the judge, jurors, his attorneys and prosecutors. The son of former Senate President Emil Jones Jr., he was the first sitting member of the state General Assembly to have a jury trial at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse since then-state Rep.

Turn to Mistrial, Page 5

Stratton 1st major Dem to bid for Durbin's seat

Lieutenant governor announces Senate plans on social media

By Rick Pearson, A.D. Quig and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton wasted little time in formally launching her bid for the U.S. Senate seat being vacated by Sen. Dick Durbin, becoming the first major Democrat to enter a race that is expected to attract a large field of contenders.

Stratton announced her plans in a video posted on social media at 5 a.m. on Thursday, less than 24 hours after Durbin declared he would not run for a sixth term in 2026. The move was designed to position herself as an early front-runner in what figures to be a highly competitive campaign.

Other Democrats who are



Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton speaks during a news conference to sign the Dignity in Pay Act into law at Access Living of Metro Chicago on Jan. 21. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

considering joining the race, including U.S. Reps. Raja Krishnamoorthi of Schaumburg, Lauren Underwood of Naperville and Robin Kelly of Matteson, spoke at public events Thursday but didn't say whether they planned to run for Senate.

The decision by Stratton, a former state lawmaker, was not a surprise. The state's lieutenant governor under Gov. JB Pritzker since 2019, Stratton announced in late January her interest in

Durbin's seat if he decided not to run, and she formed a federal political action committee. Stratton has also sought to increase her public visibility and boosted staffing in recent weeks as she awaited Durbin's decision.

Just hours after Stratton's announcement, the Democratic Lieutenant Governors Association endorsed Stratton and said it would commit "seven figures"

Turn to Senate, Page 4

Trump rebukes Putin after attack on Kyiv

Russia hit the city with barrage of missiles, killing at least 12 people

By Vasilisa Stepanenko and Samya Kullab
Associated Press

KYIV, Ukraine — Russia pounded Kyiv with an hours-long barrage of missiles and drones Thursday, killing at least 12 people in its deadliest assault on the Ukrainian capital since July and drawing a rare rebuke of Moscow from President Donald Trump just as peace efforts appeared to be coming to a head.

The attack kept residents on edge for about 11 hours, with many staying awake all night while loud explosions reverberated around the city and flashes of light punctuated the sky. Families gathered in public air-raid shelters, some of them bringing cats and dogs. The strikes that began around 1 a.m. hit at least five neighborhoods and heavily damaged multiple residen-

tial buildings. Around 90 people were wounded.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said he would cut short his official trip to South Africa and return home as the city reeled. The bombardment appeared to be Russia's biggest attack on Kyiv in nine months, and Zelenskyy called it one of Russia's "most outrageous."

Trump, who has long been reluctant to criticize the Kremlin, said he was "not happy" with the assault. He implored Russian President Vladimir Putin to cease the devastating strikes.

"Not necessary, and very bad timing. Vladimir, STOP! 5000 soldiers a week are dying," Trump wrote on his Truth Social media platform, adding, "Let's get the Peace Deal DONE!"

The attack Thursday came as weeks of peace negotiations appeared to be culminating without an agreement in sight and hours after Trump lashed out at Zelenskyy. Trump accused him

Turn to Ukraine, Page 9

'It points to a larger problem'

Aldermen are spurning Mayor Brandon Johnson's new budget task force that will be charged with making far-reaching recommendations. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Turnout keeps viewing open late

So many mourners lined up to see the body of Pope Francis in a simple wooden coffin that the Vatican kept the doors open all night. **Nation & World**



Bears draft tight end

Bears hoping fist-round selection of Colston Loveland "creates creativity" in Ben Johnson's offense. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **61** Low **42**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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